

UFC

It's time! 🖐️

Battle Ready: Main Event Showdown Strategy



Addressing Revenue Decline: Strategic Event Planning for UFC's Future

- UFC Q1 and Q2 Revenue has been lower than in previous years
- Tasked with planning and pitching a main event and backup/co-main event for final five events
- Given event data from 1994-2021 from Kaggle UFC Master Dataset
- Global expansion and localized marketing are needed to maximize audience reach and revenue potential.
- Data-driven strategies and digital fan engagement are increasingly critical for event success.

5 Cities, 10 Electrifying Fights, One Global Stage: UFC's Global Knockout Tour



Etihad Arena, Abu Dhabi



T-Mobile Arena, Las Vegas



Madison Square Garden, New York



The O2 Arena, London



Jeunesse Arena, Rio de Janeiro



Fight Night Formula: Parameters for Event Success

- Each bout features two marquee fighters, building new rivalries and storylines.
- No repeat matchups, every fight is fresh, using detailed historical data (as of 2021) for eligibility.
- Weight classes: Fighters compete in the same or one adjacent class, maximizing competitive balance.
- Spotlight on current stars as well as popular retired athletes (eligible if retired within the past 3 years).
- Event Selection Highlights
 - Rigorous criteria ensure every card delivers excitement, fairness, and market appeal.
 - Locations chosen for maximum international reach and audience impact



Main Event Matchups: Balancing High Stakes & Big Rewards

Location & Venue	Fight Card	Weight Class	Reward tier	Risk Tier
Madison Square Garden, New York	(Main) Jon Jones vs. Sergei Pavlovich	Heavyweight	\$\$\$	
	(Co-main) Colby Covington vs. Shavkat Rakhmonov	Welterweight	\$\$	
Etihad Arena, Abu Dhabi	(Main) Khamzat Chimaev vs. Sean Strickland	Middleweight	\$\$\$	
	(Co-main) Islam Makhachev vs. Beneil Dariush	Lightweight	\$\$\$	
T-Mobile Arena, Las Vegas	(Main) Justin Gaethje vs. Rafael Fiziev	Lightweight	\$\$\$	
	(Co-main) Dustin Poirier vs. Arman Tsarukyan	Lightweight	\$\$\$	
The O2 Arena, London	(Main) Leon Edwards vs. Belal Muhammad	Welterweight	\$\$\$	
	(Co-main) Tom Aspinall vs. Curtis Blaydes	Heavyweight	\$\$	
Jeunesse Arena, Rio de Janeiro	(Main) Amanda Nunes vs. Irene Aldana	Women's Bantamweight	\$\$	
	(Co-main) Deiveson Figueiredo vs. Petr Yan	Flyweight vs Bantamweight	\$\$	

 - High risk,  - Medium risk,  - safe bet

\$\$\$ - high reward, \$\$ - medium reward

Inside the Octagon: The Metrics Behind the Battle

Metrics	Weight	Normalized Score
Win Rate	35%	0.78
Total Fights	25%	0.78
Finishes(KO/TKO)	25%	0.90
Significant Strikes	10%	0.80

Fighter 1

Popularity Index_{Fighter 1} = (0.35*0.78) + (0.25*0.76) + (0.25*0.90) + (0.10*0.80) = 0.77

Popularity Index_{Fighter 2} = (0.35*0.73) + (0.25*0.80) + (0.25*0.83) + (0.10*0.71) = 0.73

Combined Popularity Index = PI_{Fighter 1} + PI_{Fighter 2} = 1.5

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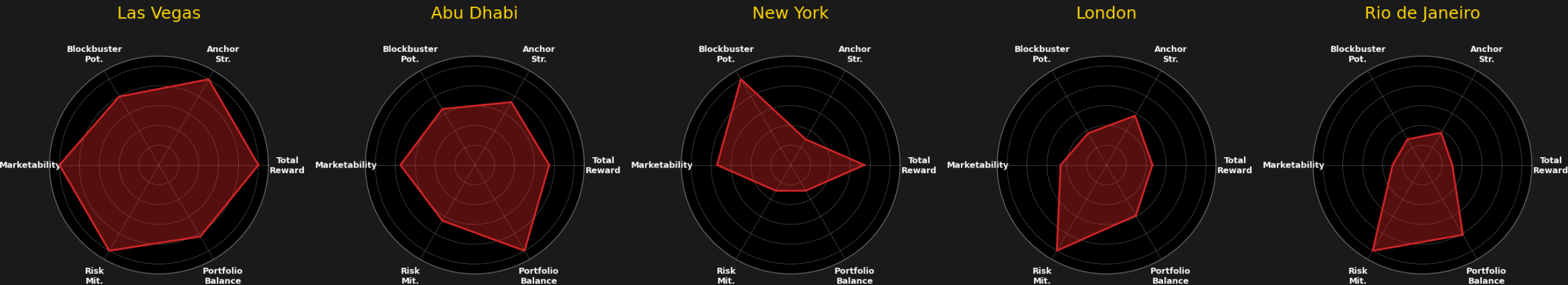
Fighter 2

Note: Weights do not total 100% as they reflect regression-derived importance, not percentage allocation.

Unleashing Potential: Comparative Event Analysis

- **Las Vegas:** Highest Total Reward, strong expected PPV sales from the main event.
- **New York:** Highest Blockbuster Potential, but lowest Portfolio Balance (large PPV disparity) and lowest Risk Mitigation (higher risk).
- **Abu Dhabi:** Highest Portfolio Balance (even PPV distribution) and good Marketability.
- **London:** Moderate performance across most metrics, relatively high Risk Mitigation (lower risk).
- **Rio de Janeiro:** Lowest Total Reward, Anchor Strength, Blockbuster Potential, and Marketability (lower expected PPV and popularity). High-Risk Mitigation and Good Portfolio Balance.

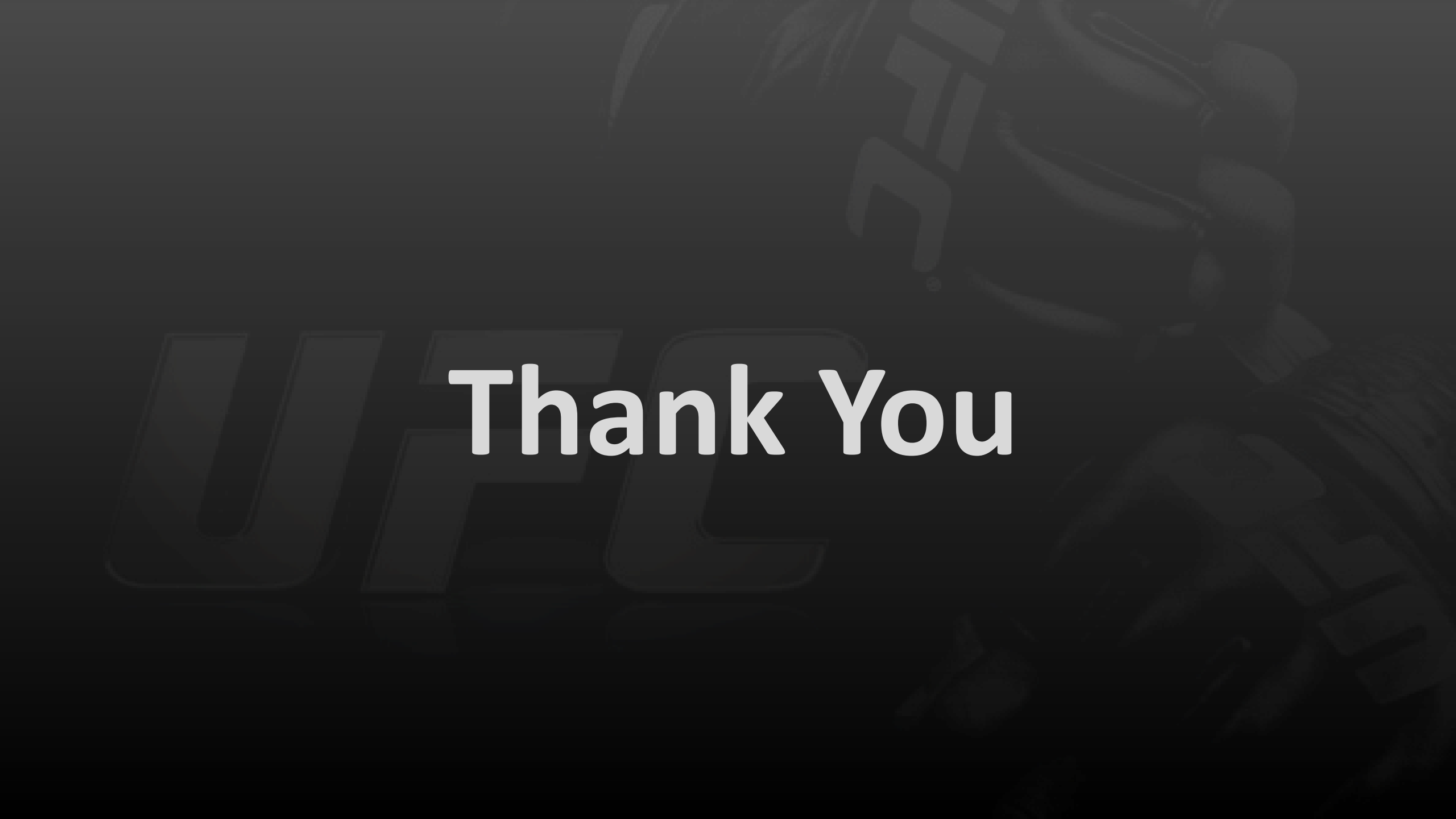
Proposed Events



The main and co-main matches for each city have been taken into account for the event rankings.

Maximizing Impact: Investment & Returns Across Key UFC locations

Location	Media & Marketing (\$M)	Fighter Payouts (\$M)	Venue & Operations (\$M)	Total Investment (\$M)	Expected ROI	Expected Return (\$M)
Las Vegas 	8	20	15	43	55%	23.65
Abu Dhabi 	4	12	8	24	65%	15.60
New York 	7	18	12	37	60%	22.20
London 	3	10	6	19	68%	12.92
Rio de Janeiro 	2	8	4	14	75%	10.50

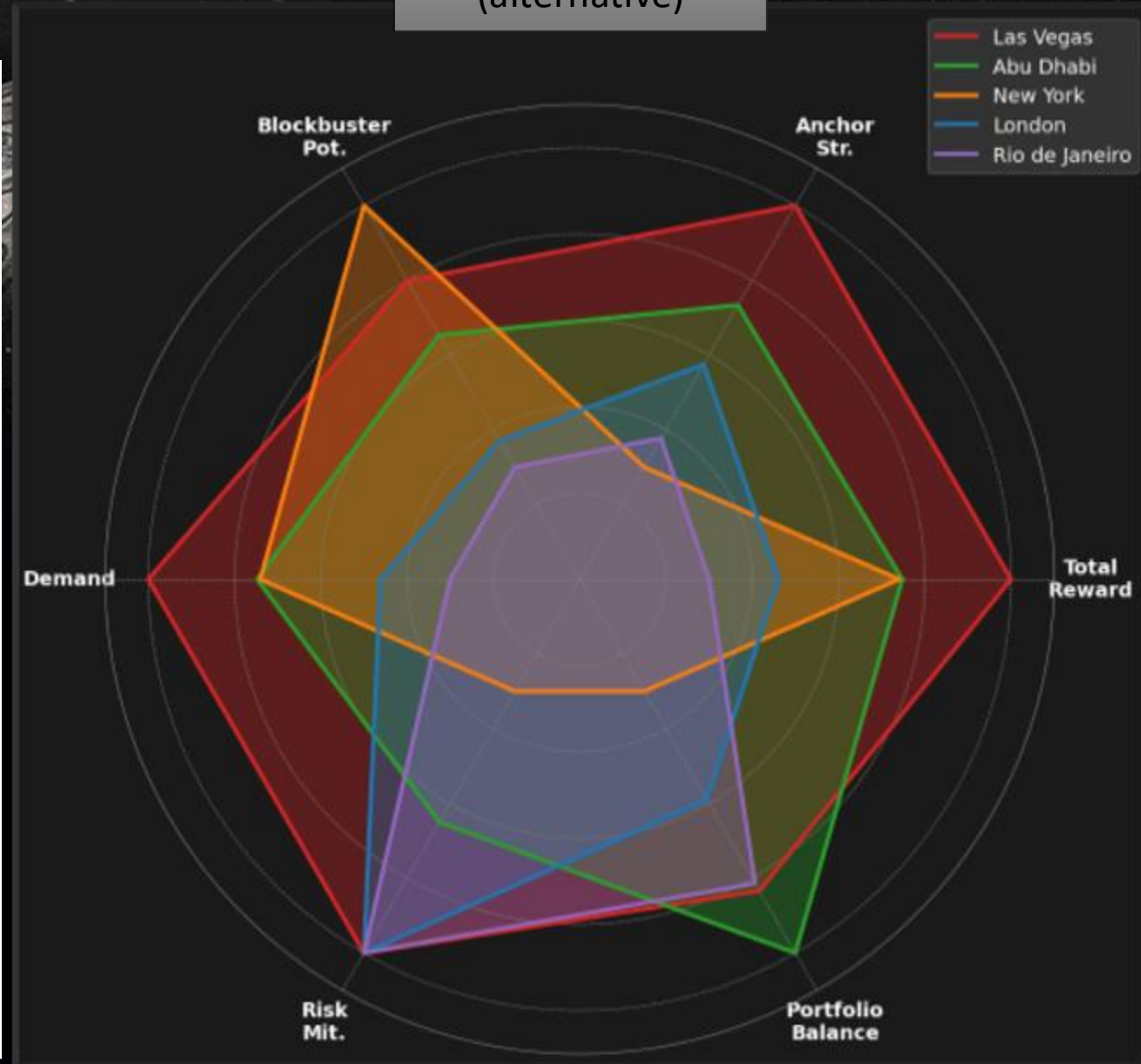


Thank You

Unleashing Potential: Comparative Event Analysis

Combined graph
(alternative)

- **Las Vegas:** Highest Total Reward and Anchor Strength, strong expected PPV sales from Anchor.
- **New York:** Highest Blockbuster Potential, but lowest Portfolio Balance (large PPV disparity) and lowest Risk Mitigation (higher risk).
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